

JON BAKER

Jon Baker Opens Six Clear

An 85 on a course he had never seen, bookended by five unblemished holes at the start and three pars at the finish, gives him the early lead in both the TEG 13 Trophy and the TEG 13 Green Jacket.

Jon Baker opened the 2020 TEG at Royal Cinque Ports Golf Club with 39 points. It was the best score of the day. The field's total spread ran from 28 up to that 39, a range that speaks less of competition than of triage.

The foundation was laid early and laid cleanly. Pars at the first, the second and the fourth. A birdie at the par-5 3rd, one of the harder holes on the card. A par at the 5th to round off five holes without a dropped shot.

That opening burst was worth 10 stableford points across its first three holes alone. Nobody else was doing anything of the sort.

He then closed with three more pars, from the 16th through the 18th, and brought the round home without further alarm. It put him top of both the TEG 2020 Trophy and the TEG 2020 Jacket after the opening round. He had never played the course before. His 85 gross set the mark he would need to chase across the rest of the tournament.

AT A GLANCE
ROUND OF THE DAY Jon BAKER (39 pts)
TROPHY LEAD Jon BAKER, 6 ahead
GREEN JACKET LEAD Jon BAKER, 9 ahead

ROUND STABLEFORD
JB 39 GW 33 AB 31 DM 31 JP 28
ROUND GROSS
JB +13 DM +22 GW +22 AB +30 JP +36

AFTER R1 • TROPHY
JB 39 GW 33 AB 31 DM 31 JP 28
AFTER R1 • GREEN JACKET
JB +13 DM +22 GW +22 AB +30 JP +36

WOODEN SPOON

John Patterson Adrift at the Foot

Four of the five players held last place at some point on Thursday, but only one of them was still holding it when the cards were signed.

John Patterson had the worst round in the field at Royal Cinque Ports. He carded 28 points on 36-over gross. That is the lowest Trophy score of the day and the highest gross, a double that required real commitment.

The damage arrived in instalments. A quadruple bogey at the 1st, to establish the tone. A quintuple bogey nine at the 7th, to confirm it. Another quadruple at the 10th. Then a run from the 9th to

the 11th that bled eight shots in three holes. A second quadruple bogey at the 16th, a par-5 of stroke index 7, was by that stage an administrative formality.

The bottom of the TEG 13 Wooden Spoon race did change hands four times over the round, though the traffic was routine rather than dramatic. Gregg Williams occupied the spot twice, at the 3rd and again at the 5th. David Mullin took his turn

after a double bogey at the 4th. Both were released. Patterson's double bogey at the 2nd, followed in due course by the quadruple at the 16th, secured the position permanently.

He finished three points adrift at the foot of the field. Jon Baker led both the Trophy and the TEG 13 Green Jacket after the opening 18.

DAVID MULLIN | GREGG WILLIAMS

Gregg Williams and David Mullin Rally

Identical gross totals, near-identical shapes of round, and one well-timed birdie each to thank for it.

Round one at Royal Cinque Ports Golf Club was a grind for Gregg Williams and David Mullin alike. Both carded 94 gross. Both found exactly one hole on which to halt proceedings.

Mullin's round began in trouble and stayed there. A triple bogey at the 1st. Bogeys at the 2nd and 3rd. A double bogey at the 4th. Four straight holes without a par, and then, at the par-5 5th, one of the harder holes by stroke index, a birdie. It arrived like a telegram from a better round happening elsewhere.

Williams had the same story, only worse. After a double bogey at the 13th and a bogey at the 14th, he birdied the 15th, which is Royal Cinque Ports' hardest hole by stroke index. Handsome work. It also changed nothing, because earlier he had dropped six shots across three holes, from the 5th to the 7th. Three double bogeys in a row, not a net par among them. For both men, one birdie apiece was the only thing standing between a bad round and something considerably less dignified.

ALEX BAKER

Eighteen Shots Lost in Seven Holes

Alex Baker managed the rare feat of shedding nine gross shots before the turn and then doing it again straight afterwards, the quadruple bogey at the 11th the worst of it.

Alex Baker's opening round at Royal Cinque Ports never got going. A double bogey at the 4th was merely the overture. He then ran triple bogey, double bogey, double bogey through the 5th, 6th and 7th, losing nine shots in that four-hole stretch. The par-5 5th, the second-hardest hole on the course, took a triple in the middle of the slide.

The back nine offered nothing. A double bogey at the 10th. A quadruple bogey at the 11th, one of the harder holes out there. A triple bogey at the 12th. Another nine shots gone in three holes, and three consecutive holes without a net par to show for any of it. That second collapse also dropped him to the bottom of the Wooden Spoon race, from third to fifth, which is a long way to fall in ninety minutes.

Between the two stretches, Baker lost eighteen gross shots in seven holes. He finished round one on 102. The other eleven holes were, by comparison, a sanctuary.

RECORDS & PERSONAL BESTS

Notable achievements: TEG 13, Round 1